

Speaking Evaluations Explained

Speaking Evaluations – One Class Only

When

Speaking evaluations should be completed in one class – for E6 this is imperative, but for other levels it should be strived for and is possible.

Class Flow

- Explain speaking evaluations
- Explain the evaluation form
- Set the work/activities that students can complete when waiting/watching
- Set up inside/outside the classroom and begin the evaluations
 - o Evaluation length (Depends on class size and how long the set-up takes)

Notes on Evaluation Length

- If you have a full class of 15/16 students, the timing would roughly be
 - o 5 minutes explanation (in the previous class/5 minutes setup (on the day)
 - o 2 minutes speaking per student
 - o 1 minute for change over between students
- For 10ish students
 - o 5/10 minutes for set up
 - o 3 minutes speaking per student
 - o 1 minute for change over between students
- For smaller classes
 - o Spend 3 or 4 minutes per students and then use the remaining time for something else.

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How to

I know that many teachers have never done this before and it can be fairly busy with larger classes. Here is how to manage your time, with tips as sub-points.

- When you explain speaking evaluations, **be clear about time limits** and ensure all students understand what it means if they overrun.
 - If students overrun, be strict – if they overrun, cut them off and move on.
 - This can make comments difficult – you may refer to their typical speaking ability to have something to comment on
 - This also helps them understand it's their responsibility to use the time well and not sit thinking for too long.
 - If students are dragging their feet to come to you/the front, let them know it is eating into their performance time.
 - If you are outside, you can ask KT co-teachers to ensure students are moving quickly.
- Set the student order **ahead of time** and present it clearly on the board.
 - This can be either written up by hand on the board
 - Or printed on large paper ahead of time to save a few minutes
 - This helps get out all the complaints about order at once rather than springing up every time a student is summoned.
 - This could cause complaints of unfairness of preparation time.
 - For 1-on-1 interviews, you can share the topics with the next performing student, e.g. when you call student 3 to come and talk to you, student 3 gives the topic list to student 4, who then can see and prepare before they are called and give the topics to student 5.
 - Additionally, the topic list could be in a dedicated seat near the door to help make turnover swift
 - For presentations, you can institute a similar guideline, only reviewing one's script during the student before you, or merely disallow any script reviewing when anyone is performing.
- Grade (discreetly) **while students are talking** – if necessary just note down keywords to aid memory later.
 - While students are changing over, use that time to flesh out your notes as much as possible.
 - If grades are not complete at this point, move on and start with the next student and complete grading in your designated break times on your schedule.
 - If you or your co-teacher are recording, this can make this easier.
- **All evaluations must be done in one class.** Failure to do so reflects either a failure to plan on your part, or failure to execute.
 - If students miss the evaluation class, communicate with your co-teacher about how to give them an opportunity.